Innovations in Assessment UX Audit

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Overview: This audit evaluates the user experience of the *Innovations in Assessment* section on NBME.org across desktop, tablet, and mobile devices. It identifies key usability issues and provides actionable recommendations to improve accessibility, consistency, and responsiveness.

Innovations in Assessment - Homepage

1. **Hero Section**

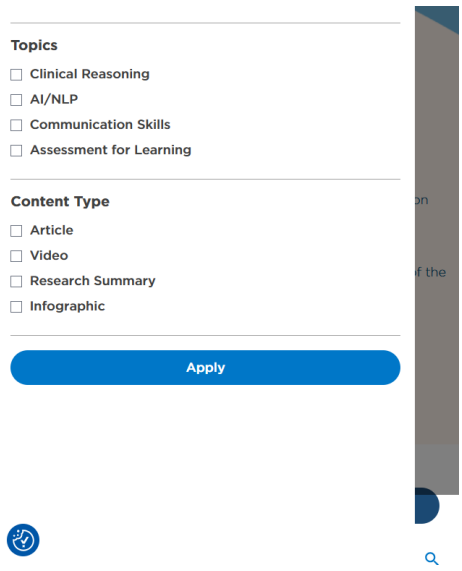
- The hero image and text occupy the entire viewport on mobile/tablet, pushing key content below the fold.

  Recommendation: Reduce hero height on smaller screens and ensure the sub-header remains fully visible.



2. **Missing Mobile Navigation**
    - The navigation bar disappears on tablet/mobile; no hamburger menu is present. **Recommendation:** Implement responsive navigation with a hamburger menu.

3. **Filters Modal**
    - On tablet, the filters modal is cut off at the top, making the “X” close button difficult to access.
    - **Recommendation**: Adjust vertical alignment using margin or transform properties to ensure full visibility.



4. **Browse Topics Label**
    - The “Browse Topics:” label is missing on smaller viewports.
    - **Recommendation:** Ensure all contextual labels remain visible across breakpoints using fluid layouts.

5. **Inconsistent Headers Alignment**
    - “Featured Article” and “Clinical Reasoning” are center-aligned on desktop, while others (AI/NLP, Communication Skills, etc.) are left-aligned.
    - On tablet, header alignment shifts and appears off-center.
    - On mobile, “Clinical Reasoning” is left-aligned while “Featured Article” is centered again.
    - **Recommendation:** Choose either left alignment or uniform centering and apply consistently across all headers.

Featured Article



Assessment for learning in medical education

Assessment for Learning

Video • 5 minute watch

Clinical Reasoning

Discover our work to create a novel approach to assessment focusing on the process of clinical reasoning.

Featured Article



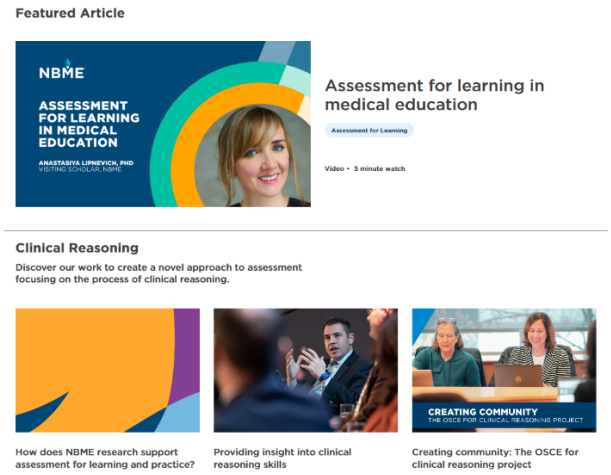
Assessment for learning in medical education

Assessment for Learning

Video • 5 minute watch

nical Reasoning

6. **Divider Styling**
    - Section dividers stretch edge-to-edge on mobile, exceeding content padding.
    - **Recommendation:** Ensure dividers respect content margins using container constraints.



7. **Title Case & Contextual Intros**
    - Inconsistent title casing (e.g., “Assessment for learning in medical education”) and some titles are overly long.
    - **Recommendation**: Use consistent Title Case for all section titles and article headings, limiting to 15 words. Add short intros for context and screen reader accessibility. Match article URLs to titles for clarity and SEO.

Innovations in Assessment – Clinical Reasoning Category

Page: How does NBME research support assessment for learning and practice?

- Replace numbered list with bullet points
- Update “DOWNLOAD THE SUMMARY” to “Medical Leaders Summary (PDF)”

Page: Providing insight into clinical reasoning skills

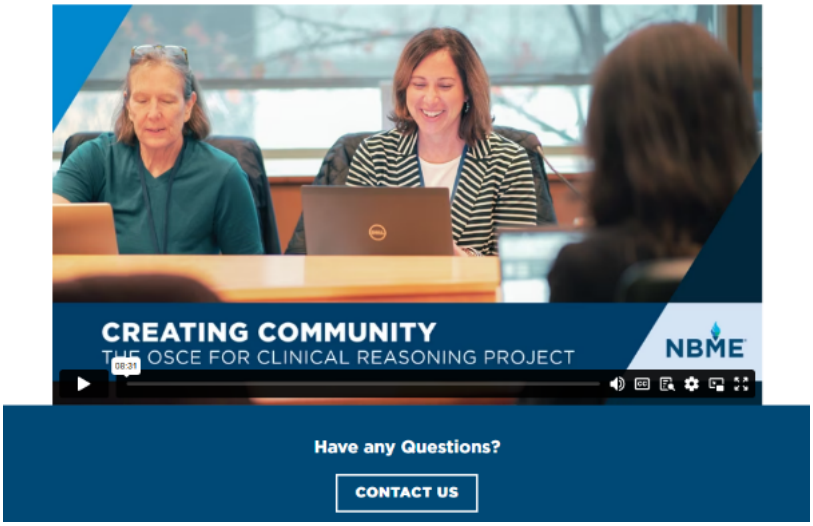
- Replace numbered list with bullet points
- Add a colon to each listed header (e.g., “More practice:”)
- Ensure superscripts link directly to corresponding footnotes

[1] NBME. https://www.nbme.org/research/research-collaborations/assessment-alliance. Accessed August 7, 2024.

[2] Mislevy, R. J., Almond, R. G., & Lukas, J. F. (2003). A brief introduction to evidence-centered design. ETS Research Report Series, 2003(1), i-29.

Page: Creating community: The OSCE for clinical reasoning project

- Add bottom padding below the video

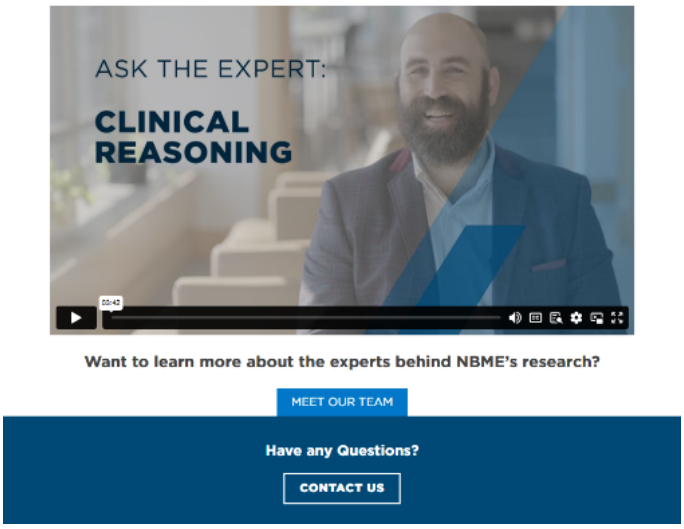


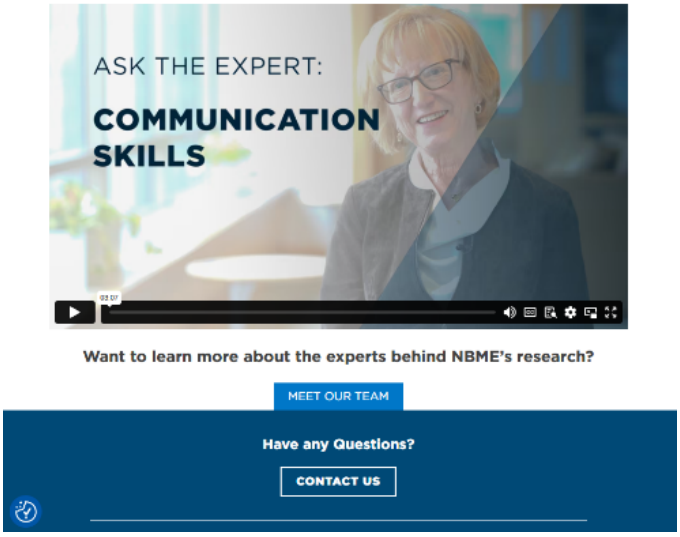
Page: How can OSCEs evolve to meet the needs of both educators and learners?

- Reword “Click the thumbnail below…” to be device-agnostic (e.g., “Tap or click the thumbnail…”)
- Ensure the linked PDF opens in a new tab/window

Page: Ask the Expert: How can research on clinical reasoning impact the future of medical education assessment? | Ask the Expert: What is validity and how can it impact the assessment of clinical reasoning and teamwork?

- Add bottom padding under “MEET OUR TEAM” button





Innovations in Assessment – AI/NLP Category

Page: Harnessing recent AI advances in medical education assessment

- Clarify voice in text ("My team…" – specify speaker)
- Standardize category name to "AI/NLP" throughout body text
- Move "Take a deeper dive…" to bottom of all articles and consider renaming to "Read More NBME Research"
- Bold initiative titles and add colons in bullet list

challenges. Examples of such initiatives include:

- The BEA'24 Shared Task on Automated Prediction of Item Difficulty and Item Response Time. In this research competition, we've challenged researchers to develop innovative ways for automated prediction of item difficulty and response time — a key requirement for automated generation of test items at desired difficulty levels. The approaches developed by the competing teams will be published in an open-access form in the Association of Computational Linguistics' (ACL) Anthology.
- NBME's Kaggle competition on Automated Scoring of Clinical Patient Notes. This competition tackled the most significant barriers in the automated scoring of OSCE assessments. Approximately 1500 teams from around the world competed to score patient notes from the former USMLE Step 2 Clinical Skills exam. The full code of all winning solutions is available on the competition's website.
- Natural Language Processing in Assessment, an NBME Educational Virtual Conference and the resulting NCME book series volume *Advancing Natural Language Processing in Educational Assessment*. The conference provided a forum for researchers from the NLP, assessment, and medical education fields to discuss new ways to use NLP/AI to improve assessment. The result of the conference learnings was a first-of-its-kind book that provides evidence-based practices for the use of NLP in assessment.

Page: The future of natural language processing (NLP) in medical education assessment

- Change "DOWNLOAD RESEARCH SUMMARY" to "NLP Research Summary (PDF)" and ensure it opens in a new tab
- Ensure "Deeper dive…" appears at the bottom
- Move links like "NBME Research Library" into the "Deeper dive…" section

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Innovations in Assessment – Communication Skills Category

Page: How can guided reflection and thoughtful feedback transform learners into empathetic and effective communicators?

- Use Title Case for "Suggested Reading" without a colon
- Ensure all resources are linked and open in a new tab/window

Suggested reading:

Cantillon, P., & Sargeant, J. (2008). Giving feedback in clinical settings. *BMJ, 337*, a1961.

Kluger, A. N., & DeNisi, A. (1996). The effects of feedback interventions on performance: a historical review, a meta-analysis, and a preliminary feedback intervention theory. *Psychological bulletin*, 119(2), 254.

Lipnevich, A. A., & Smith, J. K. (2022). Student–Feedback Interaction Model: Revised. Studies in Educational Evaluation, 75, 101208.

Watling, C., & Ginsburg, S. (2019). Feedback in the clinical environment: How critical is the learner-teacher relationship? *Medical Education*, 53(1), 10-20.

Wisniewski, B., Zierer, K., & Hattie, J. (2020). The power of feedback revisited: A meta-analysis of educational feedback research. *Frontiers in psychology*, 10, 487662.

Have any Questions?

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